

Above all	Most importantly
About to	Almost ready to
Add up	Make sense; be logical
All at once	Suddenly; without warning
All of a sudden	All at once; suddenly
As a matter of fact	In reality; actually
As a rule	Generally; customarily
At the drop of a hat	Quickly; without any preparation time
As case	Not nervous; calm
Back out (of)	Withdraw an offer
Bank on	Depend on; count on
Be my guest	Do what you want; feel free; help yourself
Be rusty	Need practice or review
Beats me	I don't know; I have no idea (often used in response to a question)
Better of	In an improved condition
Bite off more than one	Take on more responsibility than one can
Chew	Handle
Bound to	Certain to; sure to
Break down	Stop functioning (a machine, for example)
Break in (on)	Interrupt
Break the ice	Break through social barriers (as at a party)
Break the news (to)	Inform; give bad news
Break up	End (a meeting, for example)
Break up (with)	Stop being a couple a couple (a boyfriend and girlfriend, for example)
A breeze	Something very simple and easy to do (1) raise (a child); (2) introduce (a topic, for example)
Brush up on	Review; study; practice
Bump into	Meet unexpectedly ; run into
By and large	Mostly; generally; on the whole
By heart	By memory; learned word for word
By no means	In no way; not at all
Call off	Cancel
Call on	Visit
Calm down	Relax
Care for	(1) take care of; (2) like; feel affection for
Catch on	Become popular
Catch on (to)	Understand. Learn
Catch up (with)	Go as fast as; catch
Check in (or into)	Register (at a hotel)
Check out (of)	(1) clarify; make understandable; (2) become nice and sunny (used to talk about the weather)
Come across	Find; meet; encounter

▪ Come around (to)	Begin to change one's opinion; begin to agree with
▪ Come down with	Become sick with (an illness)
▪ Come up with	Think of (an idea)
▪ Cost an arm and a leg	Be very expensive
▪ Count on	Depend on; rely on; bank on
▪ Count out	Eliminate; no longer consider as a factor
▪ Cut off	Stop; discontinue (a service, for example)
▪ Cut out for	Have an aptitude for; be qualified for
▪ Day in and day out	Constantly; for a long time
▪ Die down	Become less severe; quiet down
▪ Do over	Do again; repeat
▪ Do without	Not have
▪ Down the drain	Wasted; done for no reason (work, for example)
▪ Dream up	Invent; think of; come up with
▪ Drop in (on)	Visit informally
▪ Drop (someone) a line	Send someone a letter
▪ Drop off	(1) leave something (a package, for example), (2) take (someone) home; let someone out of a eat
▪ Drop out (of)	Stop attending (classes, for example)
▪ Easy as pie	Very simple; a piece of cake
▪ Easy bigger than one's stomach	Said of someone who takes more food than he or she can eat
▪ Fall behind	Not move as quickly as; lag behind
▪ Fall through	Fail to happen
▪ A far cry from	Not similar to. Not as good as
▪ Feel free	Do something if one wants
▪ Feel like	Be inclined to; want to
▪ Feel like a million dollars	Feel very good
▪ Feel free	Do something if one wants
▪ Feel like	Be inclined to; want to
▪ Feel like a million dollars	Feel very good
▪ Feel up to	Feel able to do something; ready to
▪ Feed up (with)	Not able to tolerate; disgusted with; annoyed by
▪ Few and far between	Uncommon and infrequent
▪ Figure out	Understand. Solve
▪ Fill in	Write in a blank (on an application form, for example)
▪ Fill in (for)	Substitute for
▪ Fill one in	Provide missing information
▪ Fill out	Complete (an application form, for example)
▪ Find out	Learn; discover
▪ A fish out of water	Someone not in his or her normal surroundings
▪ Fix up	Repair. Renovate
▪ Follow in one's footsteps relative)	Do what someone else did (especially an older
▪ For good	Permanently; forever
▪ For the time being	Temporarily; for now
▪ From out of the blue	Unexpectedly; without warning
▪ Get along with	Have good relations with
▪ Get carried away	Go too far; do too much; buy too much

▪ Get in one's blood	Become a habit; become customary
▪ Get in over one's head	Take on too much responsibility
▪ Get in the way	Block; obstruct
▪ Get in touch with	Contact
▪ Get the hang of something	Learn how to do something
▪ Get a kick out of (doing something)	Enjoy; have fun doing something
▪ Get off	Leave (a vehicle)

▪ Get off the ground	Start to be successful
▪ Get on	Board (a vehicle)
▪ Get over	Recover from (a disease)
▪ Get rid of	Discard; no longer have
▪ Get under way	Begin; start
▪ Give away	Distribute (for free)
▪ Give (someone) a cold shoulder	Act unfriendly toward someone; ignore
▪ Give a hand	Applaud; clap
▪ Give a hand (with)	Assist
▪ Go easy on	Not punish severely
▪ Go on (with)	Continue
▪ Go with	(1) accompany; (2) look good together; complement (for example, two articles of clothing)
▪ Go without saying	Be clear; be obvious
▪ Grow up	To mature; to become an adult
▪ Hand in	Give back to; return
▪ Hand out	Distribute
▪ Hang on	Wait
▪ Hard to come by	Difficult to find
▪ Have on	Wear
▪ Have one's hands full	Be very busy; have a challenging job
▪ Have a heart	Be compassionate; show mercy
▪ Have a hunch	Have an intuitive feeling
▪ Have a word with (someone)	Talk to someone briefly
▪ Have the time of one's life	Have fun; have a great time
▪ Hear firsthand (from)	Get information directly from someone
▪ Hear from	Be contacted by; be in touch with
▪ Hear of	Know about; be familiar with
▪ Hit it off	Become friendly (especially at a first meeting)
▪ Hit the road	Leave, go away
▪ Hold on (to)	Grasp
▪ Hold still	Not move
▪ Hold up	Delay
▪ In hot water	In trouble
▪ In the dark	Not knowing; confused
▪ In the long run	Over a long period of time
▪ In no time	Very soon; very quickly
▪ In a nutshell	In summary; in brief
▪ In the same boat	In the same situation; having the same problem

- In person Face to face (not by telephone, letter, etc.)
- In store In the future; coming up
- Iron out Solve (a problem)
- Join the club Have the same problem
- Jump to conclusions Form opinions without sufficient evidence
- Keep an eye on Watch; take care of; look after
- Keep an eye out (for) Look for
- Keep on (with) Continue
- Keep track of Know where something or someone is
- Keep up (with) Maintain the same speed as
- Kill time Spend time doing unimportant things (before an appointment)
- Know like the back of one's hand Be very familiar with

□ Lay off Put out of work

▪ Learn the ropes Become familiar with; get used to; get the hang of

▪ Leave out Not include; omit

▪ Leave someone/something alone Not disturb

▪ Let someone down Disappoint

▪ Let up Decline in intensity (rain, for example)

▪ Look after Take care of; mind

▪ Look for Try to locate

▪ Look forward to Anticipate (with pleasure)

▪ Look into Investigate

▪ Look like Resemble

▪ Look out (for) Examine; read

▪ Look over Examine; read

▪ Look up (1) find information (especially in a reference book);
(2) try to locate someone

▪ Look up to Respect; admire

▪ Make ends meet Balance a budget

▪ Make a fool of oneself	Act embarrassingly
▪ Make a point of	Make a special effort
▪ Make sense (of)	Be logical and clear; understand
▪ Make up	Invent, create
▪ Make up one's mind	Decide
▪ Make way for	Allow space for; provide a path for
▪ Mean to	Intend to
▪ Mixed up	Confused
▪ Music to one's ears	Something that sounds pleasant
▪ Next to nothing	Very little (money, for example); cheap
▪ No doubt about it	Certainly; definitely
▪ No harm done	There was no damage done
▪ Not at all	Not in any way; not to any degree
▪ Not believe one's ears (or eyes)	Be unable to believe what one hears (or sees)
▪ Not think much of	Not like; not have a good opinion of

▪ Odds and ends	Small, miscellaneous items
▪ On edge	Nervous
▪ On end	Consecutively, without a break
▪ On hand	Easily available
▪ On needles and pins	Nervous; anxious
▪ On one's own	Independent
▪ On second thought	After reconsidering
▪ On the go	Always busy; always moving
▪ On the tip of one's tongue	Almost able to remember
▪ On the whole	In general
▪ Out of (something)	Not having something
▪ Out of one's mind	Insane; illogical; irrational
▪ Play it safe	Choose a cautious plan
▪ Point out	Indicate

▪ A pretty penny	A lot of money
▪ Pull one's leg	Joke with someone; make up a story
▪ Push one's luck	To continue doing something; to keep taking chances
▪ Put aside	Save for later; set aside
▪ Put away	Return something to its proper place
▪ Put off	Delay; postpone
▪ Put on	Begin to wear
▪ Put together	Assemble
▪ Put up with	Tolerate
▪ Right away	Immediately
▪ Ring a bell (with)	Sound familiar to
▪ Rough it	Experience somewhat difficult or primitive conditions
▪ Rule out	Say something is impossible; eliminate
▪ Run a temperature	Have a fever
▪ Run for office	Try to get elected
▪ Run into	(1) meet unexpectedly; bump into; (2) collide with
▪ Run late	Be late; be in a hurry
▪ Run out of	Exhaust the supply of
▪ Save one's breath	Don't bother asking someone
▪ Search me	I don't know; I have no idea; beats me
▪ See (someone) off	Accompany (to an airport or train station, for example)
▪ See to	Take care of; check on; fix
▪ Serve one right	Receive the proper punishment; get the penalty one deserves
▪ Short for	A nickname for
▪ Show around	Orient; give a tour
▪ Show off	Try to attract attention by unusual behavior
▪ Show up	Arrive
▪ Shut down	Close
▪ Sign up (for)	Enroll (for a class, for example)
▪ Sing another tune	Change one's opinion; feel differently
▪ Size up	Measure; estimate
▪ Sleep on it	Postpone a decision until the next day
▪ Slowly but surely	Gradually; steadily but not quickly
▪ Snowed under	Very busy
▪ So far, so good	Up until now, there are no problems
▪ Snowed under	Very busy

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|-------------------|-------------------------------------|
| ▪ So far, so good | Up until now, there are no problems |
| ▪ Sooner or later | At some indefinite future time |

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| ▪ Tell apart | Distinguish |
| ▪ Things are looking up
improving | The situation is |
| ▪ Think over | Consider |
| ▪ Throw away | Discard; get rid of |
| ▪ Throw cold water on
to cancel (a plan, for example) | Discourage; force |
| ▪ Throw the book at someone
maximum punishment | Give someone the |
| ▪ Try on
(for size, style) | Test clothing before buying |
| ▪ Try out
buying | Test a product before |
| ▪ Try out (for)
in a play, for example) | Audition for (a role |
| | Attempt to join (a team,
for example) |
| ▪ Turn around
direction | Face in a different |
| ▪ Turn down | (1) reject an offer
(2) decrease in intensity |
| ▪ Turn in
in | (1) return; give back; hand
(2) go to bed |
| ▪ Turn into | Change to; transform into |
| ▪ Turn off | Stop the operation (of an
appliance) |
| ▪ Turn on | Start the operation (of an
appliance) |
| ▪ Turn out
final product; | (1) result; end up; be the

(2) produce;
(3) arrive; gather (for a
meeting for
example) |
| ▪ Turn up | (1) increase in intensity;
(2) arrive |
| ▪ Under the weather | Slightly ill |
| ▪ Use up | Use completely |
| ▪ Wait on | Serve |
| ▪ Walk on air | Be very happy |
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- Warm up (1) heat;
(2) practice; prepare for
- Warm up (to) Become friendly with; start
to enjoy
- Watch out (for) Be alert; look out for
- Wear out Become no longer useful
because of wear

